HOW TO READ CODE

Reading code means tracking steps, not memorizing a language.

SCAN & LEARN

WHAT HAPPENS • FOLLOW THE ARROWS

01 READ THE LINE → 02 EVALUATE EXPRESSION → 03 FOLLOW THE VALUE → 04 OBSERVE THE OUTPUT

FOUR IDEAS TO KEEP

1 VARIABLE = A NAME TAG

"score = 3" assigns 3 to the name score. You can assign a new value later. "=" assigns; "==" tests equality.

score = 3 → score = score + 1 → score is now 4.

2 FUNCTION = A MINI-RECIPE

"len" finds length; "print" displays output. In nested calls, you need the inner call result before the outer call can finish.

print(len("Ana")) → len("Ana") = 3 → print(3).

3 NOT ALWAYS RIGHT-TO-LEFT!

There is NO general rule to read code right-to-left. Follow execution order; Python generally evaluates expressions left-to-right.

Only the INNER call must finish before its outer call.

4 IF, FOR AND INDENTATION

"if" chooses a path; "for" repeats. Leading spaces form the code blocks in Python.

if score > 3: → run the indented block if true.

TRY IT — TRACE WITHOUT RUNNING

Write: x = 2; x = x + 3; print(x). Ask everyone to predict what gets printed.

THE ONE SENTENCE TO REMEMBER

CODE changes the current STATE: "what value exists RIGHT NOW?"

Question: What does print(len("cat")) display?